



Chess Smackdown — Player's Guide

Table of Contents

Introduction	2
The Short Version	2
Starting a Game	3
Card Battles — How Fights Work	4
Sniper Cards & Armageddon	5
Check — But No Checkmate	5
King Battles — The ONLY Way to Win	6
Little Differences from Regular Chess	7
Playing Against the Computer	7
Sound & Voice.....	7
Quick Reference	8

Introduction

- Your opponent's Knight is about to capture your Queen.
- Without her, your King is outgunned and you're doomed to lose...

...but what if she could fight back???

In Chess Smackdown, you have to WIN a card battle to capture a piece...

...otherwise, **YOUR** attacking piece dies. Your opponent's piece stands his ground.

And beware the Joker....he's a **SNIPER** who will take out even more of your chess army!

The Short Version

Chess Smackdown plays just like regular chess. But we added three awesome twists:

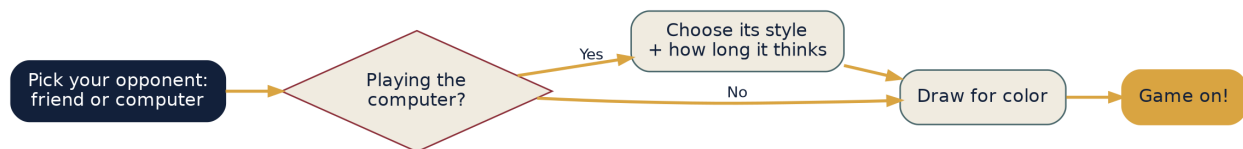
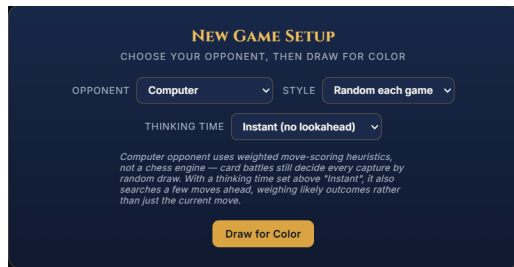
1. **You don't just take a piece — you battle for it.** Move onto an enemy piece, and you both draw a card to see who wins the fight.
2. **No checkmate.** Check is still a thing, but it can't end the game by itself. The only way to actually win is to capture the enemy King.
3. **Special cards can flip the whole fight.** A **Sniper** card (that's our name for the Joker) wins its battle no matter what, and can grab you a bonus piece. If both players draw a Sniper at the same time... buckle up. That's **Armageddon**.

Everything else works exactly like the chess you already know — castling, en passant, pawn promotion, all of it. A few tiny tweaks are explained near the bottom.



Starting a Game

Before you even see the board, you'll see the **Game Setup** screen.



Who are you playing?

- **Human (pass & play)** — You and a friend share the same screen and take turns.
- **Computer** — you're playing the AI. You also get to pick its style and how long it thinks.

Its style:

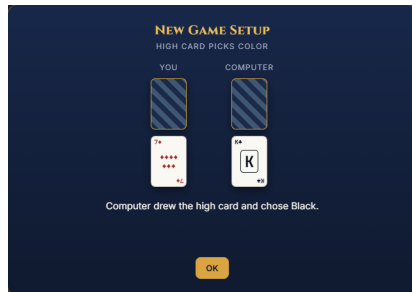
Style	What it's like
Aggressive	Attacks nonstop
Cautious	Plays it safe
Reckless	Takes wild risks
Positional	Fights to control the middle of the board
Random	Picks a different style every game

How long it thinks:

Setting	What It means
Instant	Super-fast, doesn't think much ahead
Quick (up to 5s)	A little bit of thinking
Standard (up to 15s)	Solid, balanced moves
Thorough (up to 30s)	Plans several moves ahead
Deep (up to 1 min)	Strong and patient
Very Deep (up to 2 min)	Really strong
Maximum (up to 3 min)	The AI's absolute best game

Who goes first?

You and your opponent each draw one card. Highest card gets to pick White or Black. Tie? Draw again. If you're playing the computer and it wins the draw, then it picks randomly, and you get stuck with whatever's left.

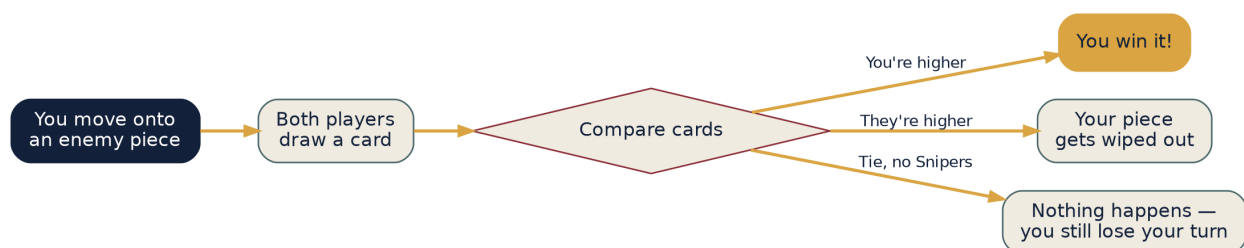


Card Battles — How Fights Work



Here's the big one. In regular chess, moving onto an enemy piece just takes it. Not here! Moving onto an enemy piece starts a **card battle**:

- You and your opponent each draw one card from your own deck.
- Whoever draws the higher card wins.



Good stuff to know:

- **Your deck is yours.** Nobody's touching your cards but you. Good luck is good luck; bad luck is bad luck — no cheating possible.
- **Losing a fight you started really hurts.** Your piece doesn't go home — it's gone for good.
- **Even a tie costs you your turn.** So don't attack unless you're feeling lucky.
- **Run out of cards?** Your deck automatically shuffles itself back up. No stress.

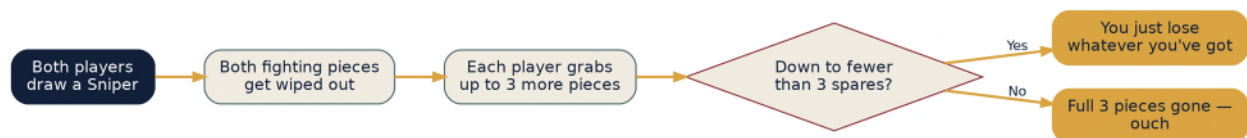
Sniper Cards & Armageddon

In Chess Smackdown, Joker cards are called **SNIPERS**. There's a reason for that. A real sniper doesn't miss — one perfect shot, target down. That's exactly what this card does: draw one, and you win the battle automatically. Doesn't matter what your opponent has.

But **WAIT**....there's more!

Win with a Sniper, and you don't just capture the piece — you get to take a **BONUS** piece from your enemy's army anywhere on the board — except the King, of course. (*We're not making it **that** easy for you!*)

But watch out — if you BOTH draw a Sniper at the same time, it's ARMAGEDDON. This is the wildest moment in the whole game. BOTH pieces die — AND BOTH sides get to pick **THREE** more pieces to take off the board (except the King)!!!



Two important safety rules:

- **Kings are 100% safe from Snipers and Armageddon.** They can never be captured this way. There's only one way to take out a King, and it's coming up next.
- **Armageddon ALWAYS happens — it never gets canceled.** Even if you're down to almost nothing, you still lose whatever pieces you have left. You could end up with just your King standing alone on the board. Brutal, but that's the game.

But don't give up! It is still possible for a lone King to win the game if he can capture the other King in a card battle.

Check — But No Checkmate

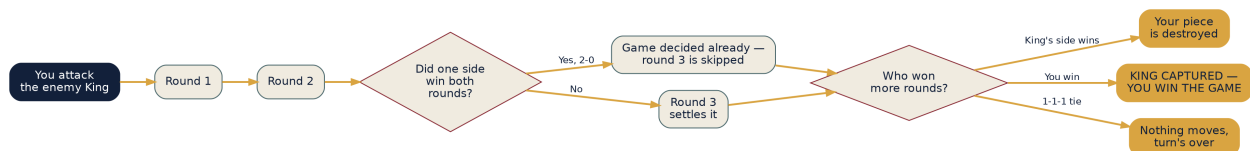
Here's the part that's most different from regular chess: **check still exists, but checkmate does NOT.**

- If your King is in danger, you'll see a **red CHECK!** badge, and your King's square will glow.
- Just like real chess, you can't make a move that leaves your own King in check — you have to move it to safety, block, or capture the attacker, if you're able to.
- But if you're truly stuck with no way out of check, the game doesn't end. You just make any legal move anyway (even one that stays in check), and the game plays a funny sound to let everyone know things are getting spicy. That's it. Nothing worse happens.



King Battles — The ONLY Way to Win

Since there's no checkmate, capturing the enemy King is the *only* way to actually win the game. Attack a King, and instead of one card battle, you get a special multi-round showdown.



Know these before you attack a King:

- **Up to 3 rounds, best score wins.** If you win the first two rounds in a row, that's already the majority — round 3 gets skipped because it can't change anything.
- **No sudden death, no do-overs.** A 1-1-1 tie (only possible if all three rounds happen) means nothing moves.
- **Snipers and Armageddon don't do their special tricks during a King battle.** A Sniper drawn here just wins that one round, like a super-high card — no bonus piece, no Armageddon.
- **If your King attacks something and loses, your King is captured immediately — YOU LOSE THE ENTIRE GAME.** Attack with your King carefully.

Little Differences from Regular Chess

Same chess rules you already know, just a couple of tiny tweaks for the card-battle system:

- **Castling works the same** (King and Rook haven't moved, nothing's in between), but your King doesn't need a totally safe path to get there — since there's no checkmate, castling only checks that you don't end up in check, not the squares in between.
- **En passant works exactly like regular chess**, and it still goes through a full card battle like any other capture.
- **Pawn promotion works exactly like regular chess** — reach the far end, and pick Queen, Rook, Bishop, or Knight.

Playing Against the Computer

When it's the AI's turn, you'll see a "**Computer is thinking...**" banner while it picks its move. How long that takes depends on what you chose at the start:

Setting	What It means
Instant	Super-fast, doesn't think much ahead
Quick (up to 5s)	A little bit of thinking
Standard (up to 15s)	Solid, balanced moves
Thorough (up to 30s)	Plans several moves ahead
Deep (up to 1 min)	Strong and patient
Very Deep (up to 2 min)	Really strong
Maximum (up to 3 min)	The AI's absolute best game

The AI's **style** changes its personality, not how smart it is — a Cautious AI thinking for the full 3 minutes is still tough to beat, it's just more careful about risks.

Sound & Voice

- The speaker icon up top mutes everything. The slider next to it controls how loud it is.
- Pieces talk trash after big moments — your browser reads it aloud.

Quick Reference

What happened	What it means
Your card is higher	You win the battle
Their card is higher	Your piece is destroyed
Tie, no Snipers	Nothing happens, but your turn's still gone
You win with a Sniper	You capture it AND grab a bonus piece
Both players draw a Sniper	ARMAGEDDON — both pieces gone, plus up to 3 more each
Attacking a King	Up to 3 rounds (stops early at 2-0). Most rounds won decides it
Your King attacks and loses	Game over — you lose

Chess Smackdown is a free game made just for fun.

© 2026 [Edward McHam](#). All rights reserved.